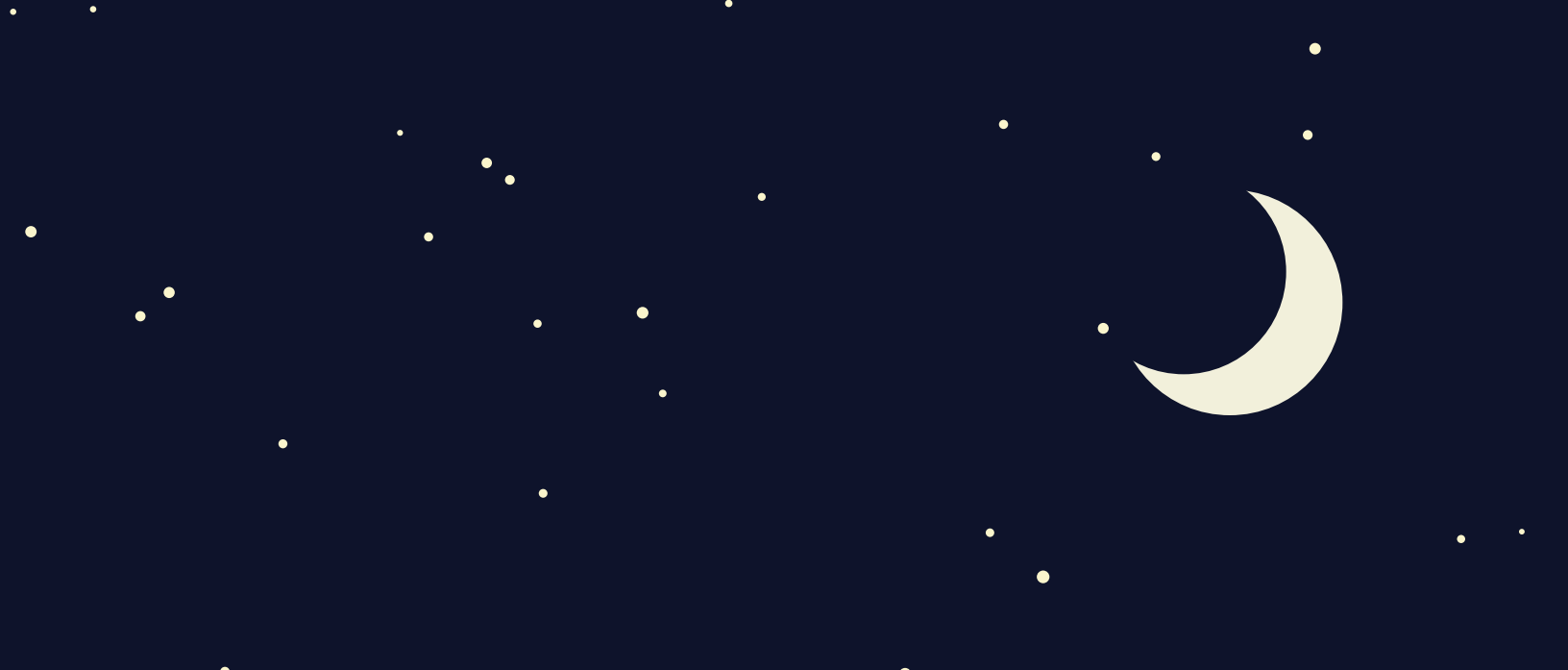




Night Fox, Guardian of the Starry Sky

picture by Echo

A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky. The bottom of the image features a dark blue gradient background with two large, curved, dark blue shapes on the left and right sides, resembling a horizon or a stylized landscape.

**A delicate thread of stars, the sky's
breath, was the world to him -- not big
enough, too small against infinity.**





**His dreams were silent echoes, wanting
more than his tiny body could hold.**





One night, the sky whispered danger.





**The breeze carried it as it danced
through the constellations.**





**His heart leapt out of place -- he wanted
to help, needed to know if it mattered.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small yellow stars scattered across the frame.

**"Am I too small?" he wondered, staring at
the distant firework's glow.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small white stars scattered across the upper half. The lower half of the image is a solid dark blue background with a few more stars and two large, dark blue curved shapes at the bottom.

**It seemed to ask him back: don't let size
tell you who you are.**



A dark blue night sky with a yellow crescent moon in the upper right and several small yellow stars scattered across the upper half.

**He tried reaching for the light through
his dreams, hoping each thread was
enough.**



A dark blue night sky with a large, bright yellow crescent moon in the upper right. Numerous small, white stars of varying sizes are scattered across the sky. The bottom of the image features a dark blue gradient background with two large, curved, dark blue shapes on the left and right sides, resembling hills or a horizon.

**The sky responded with a crackle of stars
-- it needed him.**





The End

asking for help is a kind of courage

